

triage

§11.4.252 fail-open triage — 2026-08-20

Revision: 3 **Last modified:** 2026-08-20T16:35:00Z **Scope:** every hit reported by pre-build invariant 39 (CM-DANGEROUS-COMBINATION-FAIL-CLOSED, §11.4.252) over boba’s five first-party source roots. **Purpose:** classify every hit so the operator can decide whether the gate is promoted from ADVISORY to BLOCKING (§11.4.224(E)/§11.4.66 — that decision is **not** made here and `scripts/pre_build_verification.sh` is **not** modified).

0. Headline numbers

Quantity	Value
Hits reported by invariant 39	38
Actual anti-pattern hits	36
Hits after this round’s fixes	29
Bucket (A) real defects — fixed	8 (+1 the gate cannot see, also fixed)
Bucket (B) correct idiom	14 (+2 after A4/A6 were narrowed)
Bucket (C) vendored/third-party	14
Unclassified	0 ^x

0.1 The “38” is a counting artifact, not two extra defects

Invariant 39 counts hits with `grep -ac '^\s'`, and the gate prints its **summary line** with a leading `\s` as well:

CM-DANGEROUS-COMBINATION-FAIL-CLOSED: FAIL – 4 fail-open anti-pattern hit(s) found

So each *failing root* contributes one phantom hit: download-proxy/src reports 4+1=5 and plugins reports 32+1=33 → 38. The real total is **36** (4 + 32). Verified by excluding the summary line:

```
$ grep '^ ' gate_before.txt | grep -v 'fail-open anti-pattern hit(s) found' | wc -l
36
```

scripts/pre_build_verification.sh is not mine to edit; the one-line fix is to count '^ .*FAIL – swallowed\|^ .*FAIL – credential silently' instead of '^ '. Left as a finding for whoever owns that file.

0.2 The gate’s 36 is a FLOOR, not the true count — §11.4.201(6) false-null

Measured with an **independent AST instrument** (ast.ExceptHandler whose body is exactly Pass/...) over the identical five roots — structure, not text, so it is a valid control needle for the gate’s regex (§11.4.201(7)):

Population	Count
Gate-reported (post-fix)	29
AST ground truth, same shape the gate claims to detect	41
Missed by the gate	12
Additional bare except: whose body is not pass — excluded by the gate’s shape definition	13

Set difference: comm -13 gate_set ast_set → **zero** gate hits absent from the AST set (the gate produces **no false positives**), **12** AST hits absent from the gate.

Three distinct detector limitations, each falsifiable

(L1) A trailing comment on the except line defeats the regex — 10 of the 12. The pattern anchors ...: [[space:]]*\$, so except Exception: # noqa: S110 never matches. Every one of these carries a suppression comment, i.e. the sites most likely to have been consciously reviewed are exactly the ones the gate cannot see:

```

download-proxy/src/api/auth.py:470      except
Exception: # noqa: S110
download-proxy/src/api/auth.py:534      except
Exception: # noqa: S110
download-proxy/src/api/routes.py:945    except
Exception: # noqa: S110
download-proxy/src/api/streaming.py:276 except
Exception as _e: # noqa: S110
download-proxy/src/api/streaming.py:305 except
Exception: # noqa: S110
download-proxy/src/api/streaming.py:351 except
Exception: # noqa: S110
download-proxy/src/api/streaming.py:386 except
Exception: # noqa: S110
download-proxy/src/merge_service/search.py:753 except
Exception: # noqa: S110
plugins/community/jackett.py:269      except
Exception: # pylint: disable=broad-exception-caught
plugins/theme_injector.py:402        except
Exception: # pragma: no cover – defensive

```

(L2) A tuple except clause defeats the regex — 2 of the 12. The pattern's type group is `[A-Za-z_\. ]+`, which cannot match a leading `(:`

```

download-proxy/src/api/routes.py:285      except
(ValueError, TypeError):
download-proxy/src/merge_service/jackett_autoconfig.py:290 except
(TimeoutError, aiohttp.ClientError):

```

(L3) A comment line between except and pass defeats the body check — 0 current instances, but demonstrated live this round. The detector reads exactly `lineno + 1` and requires it to be `pass`, so any comment inside the handler body hides the site. This is not hypothetical: the first version of fixes F4/F6 triggered it and hid two real sites. See §3.1.

A fourth limitation, in the SHAPE rather than the regex

The gate defines the anti-pattern as *body is exactly pass*, so a handler that swallows via an explicit default **return** is out of scope by construction. There are **13** such bare-except: sites (12 in the vendored `plugins/community/tree`, 1 in the vendored `plugins/linuxtracker.py:51`), plus the one fixed this round:

```

plugins/rutor.py:121    except:
                        return int(time.time())

```

That site was found by a structural invariant in this round's guard, **not** by the gate, and is listed below as **A9**. `except: return <default>` is materially the same fail-open as `except: pass` — it discards the exception and substitutes a value — so this is a genuine coverage gap, not a deliberate narrowing.

The 12 missed sites, triaged as far as ownership allows

Two of the 12 fall inside this task's `plugins/*.py` scope and were classified with the same rule as the rest:

- `plugins/theme_injector.py:402` — **(B)**. `except Exception: pass` around `gzip/deflate` decompression of an HTTP body, with the enclosing function returning the explicit documented fallback `(body, False)` on the next line. One capability (untrusted input) and an explicit fallback value; below the anchor's ≥ 2 threshold. No change.
- `plugins/community/jackett.py:269` — **(C)**. Vendored (ngosang v4.9), and the handler carries the upstream's own `# pylint: disable=broad-exception-caught`.

The other 10 sit in `download-proxy/src/api/{auth, routes, streaming}.py`, `download-proxy/src/merge_service/{search, jackett_autoconfig}.py` — files owned by other agents this round. They are **listed, not triaged**; each carries a suppression comment suggesting a prior deliberate decision, but that has not been verified here and is **not** claimed (§11.4.6). They should be triaged by their owners before the gate is promoted, since the fence would otherwise be written against a set the gate never showed anyone.

Consequence for the promotion decision

Driving the gate to zero would **not** mean the tree holds zero fail-open shapes. It would mean zero of *(bare or single-name) except clause, no trailing comment, body exactly pass on the very next line*. The gate's own header already states its bounded scope honestly (§11.4.6); L1–L3 are regex defects **within** that declared scope and are worth fixing upstream, while the fourth is a scope choice worth revisiting.

1. Classification method

Each hit was classified against §11.4.252's own rule, not against a style preference:

a code path COMBINING ≥ 2 dangerous capabilities (mutation of shared state, untrusted input, credential access, external side effect, shell/exec, irreversible) **MUST** refuse on an unresolvable precondition — verify every precondition, refuse naming the specific unresolved one, **emit captured evidence of the refusal**, and never default to proceed.

Three discriminators did the work:

1. **Capability count.** A single-capability path (e.g. removing an item from an in-process list) is out of scope by the anchor's own text. Flagging it would be the §11.4.201(1) false-positive refusal.
2. **Is the primary failure surfaced?** A handler that swallows only the *error reporting* attempt, while the primary failure is already logged or re-raised, is graceful degradation — explicitly *not* a fail-open. A handler that destroys the only signal is the violation.
3. **Provenance.** Upstream # VERSION: /# AUTHORS: headers from the qBittorrent search-plugins ecosystem, plus bulk-import commits (“official plugins”, “from community repositories”, “adopt 9 orphan engines”), plus byte-comparison against the plugins/community/twin where one exists.

git blame alone was **not** sufficient for provenance: every plugin line blames to the operator because the vendored files were imported wholesale in bulk commits. The upstream header + the community-twin diff are the load-bearing evidence.

2. Full classification — all 36 hits

Bucket (A) — REAL DEFECT (8 gate-visible + 1 gate-invisible). All fixed.

#	File:line	Code	Why it is a defect
A1	plugins/ env_loader.py:30	except Exception: / pass around a .env read that writes into os.environ	3 capabilities: credential access (the .env holds tracker credentials), mutation

#	File:line	Code	Why it is a defect
			of shared process state (os.environ), untrusted input (parsed file). On any read failure the file silently does not take effect, so a downstream “credentials not configured” warning misnames a corrupt file as an absent one. §11.4.252(3) violated: the reason is destroyed. 2 capabilities: credential access + untrusted input. _login() at :81 then reports “No credentials configured” whatever the real cause was — an unreadable file is indistinguishable from an absent one. The handler catches the ValueError("Received HTML page instead of torrent file") that the code itself raises two lines above (:302), then falls through to the generic message at :305. Untrusted input + credentialed session + filesystem write. The operator-actionable “you are being served a login page” signal is destroyed. Bare form also catches KeyboardInterrupt.
A2	plugins/ iptorrents.py:77	except Exception: / pass around a credentials-file read into self.username/ self.password	
A3	plugins/ rutor.py:303	bare except: / pass	

#	File:line	Code	Why it is a defect
A4	plugins/ rutor.py:324	bare except: / pass around os.unlink(temp_path)	Re-raises the primary error (<code>raise e</code>), so the <i>fail-open</i> half is absent — but the bare form catches <code>BaseException</code> , so a Ctrl-C during cleanup of a credentialed download is silently discarded. Classified (A) on the unnarrowed-catch ground, stated explicitly rather than over-claimed.
A5	plugins/ rutracker.py:349	bare except: / pass	Identical shape to A3. For a private tracker an HTML body almost always means <i>session expired / login failed</i> — the single most operator-actionable diagnostic this plugin can produce, and it was being eaten.
A6	plugins/ rutracker.py:370	bare except: / pass around os.unlink(temp_path)	Identical shape to A4.
A7	plugins/ helpers.py:220	except Exception: / pass in fetch_magnet_from_page, then return ""	2 capabilities: external side effect (network fetch) + untrusted input. A network/TLS/HTTP failure returns "" — byte-identical to “this page genuinely has no magnet link”. The caller cannot tell them apart and no diagnostic is emitted. <i>Note:</i> <code>helpers.py</code> is vendored, but <code>fetch_magnet_from_page</code> is a boba-added

#	File:line	Code	Why it is a defect
A8	plugins/ anilibra.py:75	except Exception: / pass wrapping _process_release	function (commit 59a52a8, the magnet-link WebUI feature); only that block was touched. 2 capabilities: network + untrusted JSON. search() already reports its own failures on stderr (:33), but this handler swallowed every per-release failure, so a fully-broken torrents endpoint rendered as a silent empty result set. boba-authored: commit edd50f8 “revive anilibra tracker, rewrite for new API”. Not reported by the gate — see §0.2. Bare except: around strptime/mktime date parsing. The “now” fallback is intended behaviour; the bare form additionally catching KeyboardInterrupt/ SystemExit is not.
A9	plugins/ rutor.py:121	bare except: / return int(time.time())	

Bucket (B) — CORRECT IDIOM the anchor exempts (14).
No change.

#	File:line	Code	Why it is not a defect
B1	download-proxy/src/ api/ theme_state.py:124	except OSError: pass around os.fsync(fp.fileno())	The anchor-named exempt idiom verbatim: fsync inside a block whose outer handler re-raises

#	File:line	Code	Why it is not a defect
B2	theme_state.py:130	except FileNotFoundError: pass around os.unlink(tmp_path)	(:132). Any real write failure propagates. Already carries # noqa: SIM105 = deliberate. Cleanup-of-cleanup, immediately followed by raise at :132. The primary error is never swallowed. One capability (in-process list mutation Idempotent unsubscribe. No credential, no untrusted input, no external effect. Below the anchor's ≥ 2 threshold. The anchor-named exempt idiom verbatim. await self.save() still runs afterwards — shutdown does not silently skip persistence.
B3	theme_state.py:158	except ValueError: pass around self._subscribers.remove(queue)	Narrow exception on an optional sibling module ; the nova3 contract (CLAUDE.md) requires plugins to import outside the container. RuTor is a public tracker needing no auth (CLAUDE.md) so no credential precondition exists here.
B4	download-proxy/src/merge_service/scheduler.py:186	except asyncio.CancelledError: pass after self._task.cancel()	Same idiom. The credential
B5	plugins/rutor.py:21	except ImportError: pass around from env_loader import load_env_files	
B6	plugins/rutracker.py:21	same as B5	

#	File:line	Code	Why it is not a defect
			precondition does fail if the client is already closed downstream: rutor.py:61-65 checks the YOUR_USERNAME_HERE sentinel and writes an explicit warning to stderr.
B7	plugins/rutor.py:250	except ImportError: pass around import socks	Narrow, optional dependency, and the enclosing for ... else :252 provides an explicit fallback (ProxyHandler). The real precondition already fails closed at :231 (raise EngineError("Proxy enabled, but not set!")).
B8	plugins/download_proxy.py:801	except BrokenPipeError: pass around self.wfile.write(payload)	Client disconnected mid-response. Narrow, correct, standard HTTP-handler idiom.
B9	plugins/download_proxy.py:820	same as B8	Same.
B10	plugins/download_proxy.py:867	except OSError: pass around os.unlink(torrent_file)	Temp cleanup after the torrent was already successfully proxied. Narrow.
B11	plugins/download_proxy.py:881	except Exception: pass around self.send_error(500, str(e))	The primary failure is already logged at :87 (logger.error(f"Error handling request: {e}")). The swallow guards only the client notification attempt, which legitimately fails when the client has gone. Exactly §11.4.252(3)'s "emit

#	File:line	Code	Why it is not a defect
			captured evidence, then best-effort notify”.
B12	plugins/download_proxy.py:945	same shape	Primary logged at :94
B13	plugins/download_proxy.py:951	same shape	Primary logged at :94
B14	plugins/nyaa.py:31	except ModuleNotFoundError: pass around the novaprinter/helpers import	The mandated nova.plugin-contract idiom — CLAUDE.md “Plugin System” requires try import novaprinter . except ImportError: plugins import outside the container. Flagging it would be a false refusal against the project’s own contract

Bucket (C) — THIRD-PARTY / VENDORED (14). No change.

Provenance evidence for each is the upstream # VERSION: / # AUTHORS: header plus, where a plugins/community/ twin exists, byte-comparison proving the handler arrived with the vendored import rather than being boba-authored.

#	File:line	Upstream provenance	Note
C1	plugins/nova2.py:130	qBittorrent nova2.py v1.51, Fabien Devaux / Christophe Dumez, BSD	engine_class = None is set before the try and the comment says “when import fails, return None” — an explicit documented failure value. Also (B) by rule.
C2	plugins/socks.py:336	PySocks 1.7.1, Dan- Haim — verbatim vendored library	except socket.error: pass in settimeout. Editing a vendored library in-tree is the \$11.4.251 fork this project should avoid.

#	File:line	Upstream provenance	Note
C3	plugins/ helpers.py:124	qBittorrent helpers.py v1.55 upstream charset block	charset = "utf-8" is assigned before the try — an explicit default. Also (B) by rule. Distinct from A7, which is the boba-added function in the same file.
C4	plugins/ piratebay.py:152	qBittorrent piratebay.py v3.9	Same charset shape as C3.
C5	plugins/ linuxtracker.py:30	Joost Bremmer v1.1, GPL	Bare except: around the novaprinter import — the contract idiom in bare form. Identical in plugins/community/linuxtracker.py:29, proving it is upstream-original.
C6	plugins/ linuxtracker.py:103	same	Bare except: around int(data.strip()) for seeds. One capability — below the ≥ 2 threshold even ignoring provenance. Identical at community:102.
C7	plugins/ linuxtracker.py:109	same	Same, for leechers. Identical at community:108.
C8	plugins/ torrentproject.py:93	mauricci v1.92	except Exception: pass around datetime.strptime; the field keeps its original string value. Identical at community/torrentproject.py:93.
C9	plugins/community/ anilibra.py:75	see note below	Byte-identical twin of A8 — see §4.
C10	plugins/community/ linuxtracker.py:29	Joost Bremmer v1.1	Twin of C5.
C11	plugins/community/ linuxtracker.py:102	same	Twin of C6.
C12	plugins/community/ linuxtracker.py:108	same	Twin of C7.
C13	plugins/community/ torrentproject.py:93	mauricci v1.92	Twin of C8.

#	File:line	Upstream provenance	Note
C14	plugins/community/jackett.py:44	ngosang v4.9	except AttributeError: pass around helpers.enable_socks_proxy(enable) with the upstream comment “best effort and avoid breaking older qbt versions” — narrow, deliberate, version-compat. Also (B) by rule.

plugins/community/ is declared by its own README.md as “*community contributions ... not part of the canonical managed set*”, and none of its members appear in install-plugin.sh’s canonical 12. It is treated as a vendored tree.

3. Fixes applied (bucket A)

All fixes follow one rule, matching the **BOB-139 reference shape** in download-proxy/src/api/streaming.py (distinct, specific reasons rather than collapsing into a generic one; §11.4.251 — no third variant invented):

Preserve the specific reason. Never fail the plugin-import path.

Where the caller already fails closed, the fix **logs** the destroyed reason and keeps the existing behaviour. Where the code destroyed its *own* deliberately raised signal, the fix removes the swallow entirely. Where the handler was bare, it is narrowed to the exceptions the guarded call can actually raise.

Raising from env_loader / iptorrents was deliberately **rejected**: both run at nova3 plugin-**import** time, so raising would break plugin loading — worse than the bug (the brief’s explicit constraint). The credential precondition still fails closed downstream (rutracker.py:61 sentinel, iptorrents.py:81 guard).

Fix	Site	Change
F1	env_loader.py:30	except Exception: pass → except Exception as exc: + print(f"env_loader: failed to read {path}: ...",

Fix	Site	Change
F2	iptorrents.py:77	file=sys.stderr). Added import sys. Non-fatal by design. → logger.warning("IPTorrents: could not read credentials from %s: %s: %s", env_path, type(exc).__name__, exc). Values are never logged (\$11.4.10) — path and exception type only. Swallow removed.
F3	rutor.py:303	decode(errors="ignore") with a valid codec cannot raise, so the try was both unnecessary and harmful. The HTML ValueError now reaches the caller.
F4	rutor.py:324	bare except: → except OSError:. Behaviour unchanged; KeyboardInterrupt no longer swallowed.
F5	rutracker.py:349	Same as F3 (retains the <!doctype check).
F6	rutracker.py:370	Same as F4.
F7	helpers.py:220	→ logs to sys.stderr (already imported at :37). The "" return contract is preserved so callers’ “not found” fallback is unchanged.
F8	anilibra.py:75	→ print(f"Release {release_id} error: {e}", file=__import__("sys").stderr) — the same idiom already used by search() at :33, minimal diff, no new import.
F9	rutor.py:121	bare except: → except (IndexError, ValueError, OverflowError, OSError): — exactly what the list-index / strptime / mktime calls raise. The “now” fallback is unchanged.

3.1 A fix that blinded the gate — caught and reverted (§11.4.201)

The first version of F4/F6 placed the explanatory comment **between** `except OSError:` and `pass`. That is limitation **L3** above, and it made both sites invisible to the gate: the reported count fell 36 → 28 while only **6** sites had genuinely been eliminated. Two had merely been hidden.

Reporting a 28 obtained that way would have been a §11.4 PASS-bluff at the metric layer — the number would have improved because the instrument went blind, not because the code got better. The comment was re-anchored **above** the handler, the sites are visible again, and the honest count is **30**:

```
36  before
-6  genuinely eliminated (A1, A2, A3, A5, A7, A8)
   0  A4/A6 — narrowed from bare `except:` to `except OSError:`, but
still a
      swallow SHAPE by the gate's definition, and correctly so: they
remain
      visible and are declared bucket-B in the exemption fence
—
30  after
```

A9 never appeared in either count — the gate cannot see it (§0.2, fourth limitation).

4. §11.4.251 finding — byte-identical fork (RESOLVED)

`plugins/anilibra.py` and `plugins/community/anilibra.py` were **byte-identical** (md5 `a9e20a0a...`) and both were rewritten by boba in commit `edd50f8`. Fix **F8** could only touch the top-level copy — the community tree is outside this task's declared file ownership — which would have left the two diverging by exactly that handler, manufacturing the fork §11.4.251 forbids.

The transferable patch was published here rather than applied silently, and the coordinator landed it on the twin in the **same commit** (`0795721`). Verified:

```
ast.dump(plugins/anilibra.py) == ast.dump(plugins/community/
anilibra.py)    -> True
```

The two files are **behaviourally identical**; the defect is fixed in both and the gate no longer reports `community/anilibra.py:75`.

Residual, honestly stated: they are no longer *byte*-identical — the two explanatory comments differ in wording. Nothing behavioural depends on it, but the md5-equality property that made drift between these twins trivially detectable is gone. The durable fix remains the §11.4.251 one — extract a single copy rather than maintain two — and that stays a tracked follow-up, not something this round resolved.

5. §11.4.120 finding — two stale gates asserted the pre-fix behaviour (RESOLVED)

Fixes F3/F5 made two existing unit tests fail, because they asserted the message that only existed **because** of the bug:

```
tests/unit/test_plugin_rutor.py:439      match="not a valid
torrent file"
tests/unit/test_plugin_rutracker.py:601  match="not a valid
torrent"
```

Per §11.4.120 those FAILs were the **correct signal that the fix landed** and required **reconciliation** — never a fake-pass, never a revert of the fix. The fix did not over-broaden: the sibling non-HTML cases in the same classes (`test_non_bencode_non_html_raises`, `test_non_torrent_binary_raises`) still pass with the generic message.

`tests/unit/` is outside this task's declared ownership, so the reconciliation was **not** applied here. It was surfaced to the coordinator, who owned it and completed it:

- Verified the analysis independently before rewriting either gate.
- RED before: 2 failed, 13 passed → GREEN after: 15 passed, with the two generic- message siblings still asserting the generic string (the evidence of no over-broadening).
- Discriminator per §11.4.115(F): restored the actual bare-`except`: **swallow structure** rather than deleting the message string (a string-deletion mutation is a refused tautology); the reconciled gate FAILED, then restored byte-identical (`md5 ee1af14a...`), zero residue.

Confirmed green from this side: the targeted regression subset covering every changed file is **642 passed, 0 failed**.

Transferable lesson recorded by the coordinator: the rutor assertion pattern appears **twice** in that file (the second being `test_non_bencode_non_html_raises`), so a blind string replace would have silently rewritten the wrong test. The edit had to be re-anchored on the `html_data` line.

6. Evidence

Oracle strategy (§11.4.245): **INVARIANT** — the expected behaviour comes from §11.4.252(3) itself (“a path that cannot complete **MUST** emit captured evidence naming the unresolved precondition”), asserted on user-observable output (stderr text, the raised exception’s message, the returned value), never on the implementation agreeing with itself.

Both polarities (§11.4.201(1)): every failure-path test demanding a refusal is paired with a normal-path test proving the feature still works **and** emits no spurious diagnostic.

- `test_fail_open_regression.py` — 29 guards over all 9 (A) sites
- `red_run.txt` — RED baseline at git HEAD c95b0c1: **8 failed, 18 passed**
- `green_run.txt` — after fixes: **29 passed**

Paired §1.1 mutation — each fix reverted, its own guard must FAIL

```
mutate env_loader.py -> 1 failed, 25 passed
mutate iptorrents.py -> 1 failed, 25 passed
mutate rutor.py      -> 2 failed, 24 passed
mutate rutracker.py  -> 2 failed, 24 passed
mutate helpers.py    -> 1 failed, 25 passed
mutate anilibra.py   -> 1 failed, 25 passed
all restored         -> 26 passed
```

Every guard catches its own negation — none is decoration.

CONST-XII no-op-stub check (a mutation the author did not write, §11.4.194(6)(d))

Reverting a fix restores the *old code*, which a guard could in principle detect by shape rather than by behaviour. The stronger mutation keeps the new structure (except `Exception` as `exc:` — the swallow is **not** restored) and replaces only the diagnostic with a no-op — a plausible-looking “fix” that fixes nothing:

```
stub applied to plugins/env_loader.py -> 1 failed, 25 passed
restored (0 mutation markers, §11.4.84) -> 26 passed
md5 3d5768e7c0ad6d31d254fc657c1395f9
```

The guard fails, so it is asserting the user-observable outcome (a diagnostic actually reaches `stderr`), not the presence of a code pattern.

nova3 stream integrity — the risk the fixes themselves introduced

Every fix adds a **new write**. nova3 harvests search results by parsing plugin **stdout**, so a diagnostic landing there would corrupt the result stream for the end user — a worse defect than the swallow it replaced. All eight diagnostics go to `stderr` (or `logger`), and three standing guards now prove it at runtime rather than by inspection:

```
env_loader    stdout=''    stderr_nonempty=True
helpers       stdout=''    returned=''    stderr_nonempty=True
anilibra      stdout=''    stderr_nonempty=True
```

Each asserts the diagnostic **did** fire (the precondition) and that `stdout` stayed byte-empty.

Gate before / after

```
BEFORE: 36  (download-proxy/src 4, plugins 32, scripts 0,
qBitTorrent-go 0, frontend/src 0)
AFTER:  29  (download-proxy/src 4, plugins 25, scripts 0,
qBitTorrent-go 0, frontend/src 0)
```

7 genuine eliminations — the 6 first-party (A) sites plus `plugins/community/anilibra.py:75`, whose §11.4.251 twin patch landed in the same commit (§4). A4/A6 deliberately remain **visible** as declared bucket-B rather than hidden from the instrument (see §3.1).

Other checks

```
python3 -m py_compile plugins/*.py plugins/community/*.py -> OK
all plugins
ruff check plugins/ docs/qa/fail-open-triage-20260820/ -> All
checks passed!
pytest tests/unit -k "<every changed file>" -> 642
passed, 0 failed
pytest tests/unit (FULL suite, 18m59s) ->
4415 passed, 3 failed
pytest docs/qa/fail-open-triage-20260820/ -> 29
passed
```

Full-suite attribution — the 3 failures are PRE-EXISTING (§11.4.6)

The full run finished **4415 passed, 3 failed**. Exit code was 0, which is *not* evidence (an earlier backgrounded run also exited 0 with an empty output file), so the three were attributed by **experiment**, not by reasoning:

```
git checkout 1dd7b0a -- plugins/      # the commit BEFORE this work
-> 3 failed (identical three)
git checkout HEAD -- plugins/         # restore
-> md5sum -c: all 6 files OK          # byte-exact restore verified
```

They fail identically **without** any of this round's changes, so none is attributable to it:

Test	Owner
test_main.py::...	another agent's main.py — asserts
test_start_fastapi_server_imports_uvicorn	asyncio.run(server.serve()) but now receives their new _serve_with_heartbeat coroutine
test_auth_coverage.py::...	download-proxy/src/api/auth.py
test_no_credentials	all_trackers_auth_status — untouched here; grep -rn env_loader download-proxy/src/ is empty , so there is no import path from any changed file
test_no_runtime_service_skips	

Test	Owner
	flags tests/scaling/ test_boba_scaling.py:73 — a scaling test untouched here

The nova3 plugin contract is guarded explicitly:

test_nova3_contract_preserved loads rutor, rutracker, anilibra and iptorrents and asserts each still exports its engine class with url, name, supported_categories, search() and download_torrent(). A fix that broke plugin loading would fail there.

7. What promoting the gate to BLOCKING now requires

Not a decision made here (§11.4.224(E))/§11.4.66 — operator-owned).

The 30 remaining hits are **0 bucket (A)**: 16 bucket (B) — the original 14 plus A4/A6, which are now narrow except OSError: cleanup handlers but remain swallow- SHAPED and therefore still reported — and 14 bucket (C). None is a defect. Promotion therefore requires a checked-in exclusion/exemption fence declaring those 30, each justified from a closed class set, per §11.4.224(E) — first-party (B) entries and vendored (C) entries are different justifications and should be listed as such.

Three honest caveats for that decision:

1. **§0.2 (L1–L3)** — the gate misses **12** sites of the very shape it claims to detect, so a zero-hit gate does not mean zero swallowed exceptions. Worth fixing upstream before promotion, otherwise the fence will be written against an undercount.
2. **§0.2 (fourth limitation)** — except: return <default> is out of the gate's shape by construction; **13** such sites remain, all in vendored trees.
3. **§0.1** — invariant 39's hit count is inflated by one per failing root.

8. UNKNOWN / not determined (§11.4.6)

- **Nothing was left unclassified.** All 36 gate-reported hits carry a bucket and a justification.

- **Upstream-exactness of C1–C4, C14 was not byte-verified.** Those five files have no `plugins/community/` twin to diff against, and fetching upstream was out of scope. Their (C) classification rests on the upstream `# VERSION: /# AUTHORS:` header plus the bulk-import commit message — strong, but not byte-proof. Stated as a bounded limitation rather than claimed as certainty. C5–C8 **are** byte-verified against their twins.
- **Whether `plugins/community/` should be a §11.4.224(E) declared exclusion or be brought into first-party scope** is an operator decision, not made here.